

1. **INTRODUCTION**

A. Background

iPAGE GLOBAL INC. (hereinafter referred to as "**the Company**" or the "**Company**") and its licensed subsidiaries across the globe, committed to supporting all legal requirements in accordance with the local labor law in which it operates. The Company hereby prescribed its work rules and prepared this Cultural Rule Book (CRB) as a guidance for all the Company Employees (hereinafter singularly referred to as "**Employee/Staff/You**"), which is designed to provide:

- a) a background information about the Company and its policies;
- b) a clear and concise summary of the main terms and conditions of an Employee's employment; and
- c) an outline of the Company's facilities and benefits available to the Employee.

The Cultural Rule Book (CRB) will be supplemented from time to time by memorandum issued to all Staff and supersedes any terms and conditions of employment which may have been agreed, whether verbally or in writing prior to this date. The Company through its relevant officers shall share all relevant amendments, changes, deletion or additions to the Employee's employment terms and conditions in writing.

B. Foreword

The Company was incorporated on 4th June 2022, a company engaged in the business of developing agri-tech products and services.

Company Website: [iPAGE GLOBAL](http://iPAGEGLOBAL.com)

C. General Regulations

The Cultural Rule Book (CRB) embodies the conditions of employment, rights, duties and obligations of all the Employees of the Company, and are governed by the laws of Bangladesh. The conditions and regulations of employment presented herein are in compliance with the Bangladesh Labour Act, 2006 and Bangladesh Labour Rules, 2015 along with amendments and the customs and practices of Bangladesh. This Cultural Rule Book (CRB) may be amended from time to time as required by the Company.

D. Application

The Cultural Rule Book (CRB) shall be applicable on all Permanent, Temporary and Probationer Employees of the Company as defined hereunder.

E. Definitions

- a) "Board" means the Board of Directors of the Company.
- b) "Employee(s)" means those employed as Permanent or Temporary or Probationer Employees of the Company.
- c) "Employer" or "Company" or "Board of Directors" means the Company and its

management.

- d) "Employment Contract" or "Employment Agreement" means the contract of employment or the employment agreement executed between the Company and an Employee.
- e) "Maternity Benefit" means the sum of money payable to female Employees with leave on the ground of her being a mother.
- f) "Organizational Policy" includes this Cultural Rule Book (CRB) and all such other policies of the Company including any amendments or modifications made thereunder.
- g) "Service Rules" means this Cultural Rule Book (CRB) including any amendments or modifications made hereto.

2. **GENERAL**

A. **Classification of Employees**

- a) **Permanent Employee:** A Permanent Employee is an Employee who is employed in the Company on a permanent basis, and satisfies the definition of a Permanent Worker under section 4(7) of the Bangladesh Labour Act 2006.
- b) **Temporary / Contractual Employee:** A Temporary Employee is one who is employed in the Company for works that are temporary in nature and who satisfies the definition of an employee pursuant to section 4(5) of the Bangladesh Labour Act 2006. For example, employees who are hired for a specific project for a fixed time period. Office support staff and laboratory assistants (non-degree positions) may be classified as **temporary employees**. However, upon completion of at least **four (4) consecutive years of continuous service** with the Company, and provided that no record of major regulatory violation or misconduct exists, such employees may be entitled to a **consolidated agreement**. This agreement shall outline certain benefits and obligations under this Rule Book, as deemed appropriate by the Company. The employment period of such Temporary Employee shall be clearly stated in their Employment Agreement.
- c) **Intern:** An intern is a person engaged for a period **not exceeding six (6) months** for the purpose of acquiring practical training and experience, which shall not constitute permanent employment under the Bangladesh Labour Act, 2006. Upon completion, the internship may, at the employer's discretion, lead to further engagement or termination.
- d) **Probationer:** A probationer is an employee who is serving a probationary or trial period in a job or position to which they are newly appointed, and if he is employed for the time being in a permanent post pursuant to section 4(6) of the Bangladesh Labour Act, 2006. The tenure of such probationary period shall be **not less than three (3) months and not more than six (6) months**.

B. **Appointment letter and identity card**

No Employee shall be appointed without an Offer Letter and an Appointment Letter. Every Employee shall be provided with an identity card with his/her photograph and all such relevant details as provided under the prescribed Form 6 of the Bangladesh Labour Rules, 2015 at the costs of the Company. The language of the appointment letter as well as the identity card shall be in English/Bangla. However, if it is deemed necessary, both the appointment letter and identity card can be provided in English. If the identity card is lost, the fresh identity card can be issued subject to the payment of Tk. 200/-. Any person working in the company will be given the letter of appointment only once. If the letter of appointment of any Employee is lost or damaged, the photocopy kept in his/her personal file or true copy can be supplied subject to the written application of the Employee to the HR.

The Offer letter shall contain the following format: [W Template_Offer Letter.docx](#)

The appointment letter shall contain the following format:
[W 20XX_Appointment Letter_Template.docx](#)

C. Nominee

Following the description of Form-41 of Bangladesh Labour Rules, 2015 (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply), every Employee at the time of joining the Company must nominate a person who can receive all sums payable to the Employee as wages. In the event it is not possible for the Company to pay the Employee due to his/her death or on account of his or her whereabouts not being known, the dues must:

- a) be paid to the person nominated by the concerned Employee in this behalf or the legal heir or heirs of the dead Employee in accordance with the rules;
- b) be deposited with the "Sramik Kalyan Foundation Fund" of the Bangladesh (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply) if there is no such nominee or heir or if, for any reason, the sum payable is not possible for the Company to be paid to the nominee or heir within the next 12 (Twelve) months.
- c) if the whereabouts of the concerned person nominated or the heir is not known within the next 10 (ten) years from the date of deposit of the sum with the "Sramik Kalyan Foundation Fund", the deposited sum shall be deemed to be the own money of the " Bangladesh Sramik Kalyan Foundation "(or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply).

The Employee's photo and photo of the nominated person will have to be attached in the nominee form. The heir or heirs of the deceased shall be identified by a warishan certificate or inheritance certificate provided by the government authority.

D. Records to be Maintained

The Company shall ensure that it maintains a register of Employees. An Employee's register should be preserved as per Form-8 of Bangladesh Labour Rules (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply), 2015 for Employees of all classes

working in the Company and it will be designed as per the classification of the Employees. All the descriptions of the register shall be in Bangla or English and the date will be written as per Christian calendar. If the Company maintains a digital Employees' register, then a copy of such register should be made available to the Competent Authority, if required. The Employees' register shall at least contain the following particulars of each Employee:

- a) Names of the Employee and his/her parents;
- b) Date of birth;
- c) Date of appointment;
- d) Nature of work describing designation, department or section etc.;
- e) Working hours;
- f) Interval for rest and meals;
- g) Leaves to which he/she is entitled;
- h) ID card number;
- i) Such other necessary particulars defined in this format;

Contact Information Collection Form: <https://forms.gle/M5F67XmoW8iNmZdJ7>

E. Cultural Induction Session (CIS):

- a) Cultural Induction Session (CIS) will be a part of onboarding session for any team member, be it an intern, probationary, or permanent employee.
- b) There will be two part of CIS:
 - General HR & Administrative Briefing: all types of HR policies, Administrative Policies, Software usage policies, organizational etiquettes shall be described by the Admin / HR team.
 - Department Specific Briefing: all types of department wise activities, practices, and projects shall be described by the concerned departmental team.
- c) General HR & Administrative Briefing sessions can be organized on a requirement basis even after primary onboarding.

F. Internship Period

- a. Internship within the company shall be done through Impact X Internship program.
- b. Internship tenure can be spanned up to 6 months.
- c. Interns shall receive a token remuneration to cover their transportation costs.
- d. Interns can be offered with full time placement, subject to their evaluation under

G. Probationary Period

- a) All appointments of a permanent post, unless specifically stated otherwise in the Employment Agreement, is subject to a probationary period of 6 (Six) months (or as applicable according to the country of operations).
- b) During the probationary period the Employment Agreement can be terminated by either of the parties without any reason with immediate effect.

- c) At least 7 (Seven) days prior to the end of the probation period or extension thereof, the Employee's performance evaluation shall be completed according to the appraisal and evaluation regulations mentioned earlier. If the Employee's performance is unsatisfactory, the Employment Agreement shall be terminated at the end of the probationary period by written notice.
- d) Upon successful completion of the probationary period, the Employee shall be deemed a Permanent Employee of the Company. Such confirmation of permanency shall be formally communicated in writing through a permanency letter, accompanied by the execution of a permanent employment agreement.
- e) In the event that the employment agreement is not issued or signed due to clerical or administrative oversight, the Employee shall nevertheless be considered a Permanent Employee and shall be entitled to all rights, benefits, and obligations applicable to permanent employees under this Rule Book.
- f) Upon completion of the probation period, the Employee shall be entitled to receive all benefits accorded under the Cultural Rule Book (CRB).
- g) During the probationary period, no paid leave, except for sick leave and casual leave, will be allowed unless otherwise agreed upon. Such leaves shall be given as per the clauses titled as "Sick Leave" and "Casual Leave" of this Cultural Rule Book (CRB). Leave without pay, however, may be given in case of an emergency or in exceptional cases.
- h) The provisions under this clause E() shall be applicable only to Employees appointed on a permanent position.

H. Permanent Employment Agreement

- a) All Employees will receive an Employment Agreement signed by the Employer and the Employee. The Employment Agreement shall include the name and personal details of the concerned Employee, designation, job description, duration of agreement (if appropriate), date of commencement, category of employment, place of work, period of probation (if any), hours of work, whether the position is eligible for overtime and remuneration (method of its calculation and details of any benefits or payment in kind). This Cultural Rule Book (CRB) shall be considered an integral part of the Employment Agreement.
- b) In case of any discrepancy or difference between the Cultural Rule Book (CRB) and the Employment Agreement, the former shall prevail.

I. Calculation of 1 (One) year, 6 (Six) months, and wages

- a) For the purposes of this Cultural Rule Book (CRB), an Employee who, during the preceding 12 (Twelve) calendar months, has actually worked for not less than 240 (Two Hundred and Forty) days or 120 (One Hundred and Twenty) days shall be deemed to have completed 1 (One) year or 6 (Six) months continuous service respectively.

- b) For the purpose of calculation of the number of days of an Employee, the following days shall also be counted, namely:
 - (i) the days of his/her lay-off;
 - (ii) the days of his/her leave with or without wages due to his/her sickness or accident;
 - (iii) the days of out of work due to legal strike or illegal lock-out;
 - (iv) In the case of female employees, maternity leave not exceeding 16 (Sixteen) weeks.

J. Service Record

- a) The Employer shall, at his own cost, maintain service records for every Employee employed by it. Every service record shall be kept in the custody of the Employer.
- b) Before employing an Employee, the Employer shall require him to submit his/her previous service book if the Employee claims that he/she has previously worked under any other employer. If such an Employee has any service records, he/she shall hand over it to the Employer and the Employer shall keep the service record in its own custody giving the Employee a receipt. If such an Employee has no service record, a service record shall be provided to such an Employee under sub-clause (a) of clause H of this Cultural Rule Book (CRB).
- c) If the Employee desires to keep and maintain a duplicate copy of his/her service record, he/she may do so at his/her own cost. The Employee can keep the duplicate of the service book on payment of Tk. 20/- (Taka Twenty) as the value of the record.
- d) The Employer shall hand over the service book to the Employee within 2 (Two) working days on the termination of the service of such Employee.
- e) If any Employee loses the service book which was handed over to him/her or the copy thereof, the Employee should inform this to the Employer in writing and the Employer shall provide him/her with a copy of the service book at the cost of such Employee. The cost of collecting the duplicate of the service book again shall be Tk. 30/- (Taka Thirty).
- f) The Service Book of each Employee shall be maintained in the prescribed Form-7 as provided under Bangladesh Labor Rules, 2015 (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply).
- g) The Employer will write down the necessary information of the Employee in the service record within 1 (One) month from the day of making him or her permanent. The new information of the Employee should be written down in the service record within 15 (Fifteen) days of the occurrence taking place in the following cases, such as:
 - (i) changing the pay scale or the rate of wages;
 - (ii) transferring to other branches or jobs of the same firm or different firms of the same owner;

- (iii) taking any training or acquiring special efficiency by the Employee;
 - (iv) enjoying or encashing the yearly leave;
 - (v) curtailing, discharging, dismissing, terminating from the service and resigning or taking retirement;
 - (vi) Imposing any fine and giving prize or expressing praises (provided that it can't be written down in the service book until the allegations of the misbehavior brought against the Employee are proved).
- h) The Employer will make arrangements for opening separate service records for each Employee within 15 (Fifteen) days of the appointment or after the completion of the probation period and the Company will bear the costs of taking photographs of the Employee for adding to it. The Company can preserve the service record in digital method and in that case the copy should be provided to the Employee.

K. Conduct towards female Employees

Whatever the rank or status may be of a female Employee, no person shall behave with a female Employee which may seem to be indecent or which is repugnant to the modesty or honour of that female Employee.

L. Obligations of the Employees

No Employee shall -

- a) Willfully misuse or interfere in the use of any system or appliance provided by the Employer for the purpose of securing the health, safety or welfare of the Employees;
- b) Willfully or without reasonable cause do anything which is likely to endanger himself/herself or any other person;
- c) Willfully neglect to make use of any appliance or system provided by the Employer for the purposes of securing the health or safety of the Employees.

M. Performance Evaluation & Appraisal Process

A) Evaluation for Interns & Appraisal for Post-Probationaries

- **Administrative & HR specific evaluation:** This segment will contribute 20 % of the total evaluation mark of 100. Detailed criteria under this segment has been detailed here : <external link : shall be defined by HR>
- **Departmental job description specific evaluation:** This segment will contribute 80% of the total evaluation mark of 100. Detailed criteria under this segment has been detailed here : <external link : shall be defined by department leads>
- Evaluations and appraisals for post-probationary Employees shall be formally communicated by the HR Department to the concerned Employee in accordance with the provisions of this Policy. Such communications shall be considered final, and there shall be **no further scope for consultation, appeal, or review before the Management**

Committee (ManCom).

- In the event of man-made crises, acts of God, or other force majeure circumstances beyond the control of the Company, the scheduled **salary appraisal/permanency of interns/post-probationaries may be deferred**. Furthermore, the Company may, if necessary, **adjust salary payments by limiting disbursements to the basic salary (for probationaries) in place of the full gross salary**, subject to providing prior written notification to the affected Employees.

B) Evaluation for Contractual Employees/Consultants

- Contractual employees and consultants shall execute separate agreements with the Company. Such agreements shall clearly define the scope of work, deliverables, and terms of engagement. Contractual employees/consultants shall not be entitled to the benefits ordinarily provided by the Company to its permanent employees.
- The Company reserves the right to regulate, review, and, if necessary, terminate the engagement or take appropriate corrective measures in cases of non-performance, misconduct, or breach of contractual obligations.
- In the event of man-made crises, acts of God, or other force majeure circumstances beyond the control of the Company, the scheduled **salary appraisal of contractual employees/consultants may be deferred**. Furthermore, the Company may, if necessary, **adjust salary payments by limiting disbursements to the basic salary in place of the full gross salary**, subject to providing prior written notification to the affected Employees.
- Evaluation of contractual employees/consultants shall be conducted strictly in accordance with the scope of work and performance indicators specified in their respective agreements. Decisions regarding extension, renewal, or termination of their engagement shall be made based on such evaluation under the below mentioned criteria -

Deliverables & Performance

- Completion of agreed scope of work within defined timelines.
- Quality of output measured against project objectives, standards, and client feedback.
- Initiative in problem-solving and adaptability to changing project needs.

Compliance & Professional Conduct

- Adherence to company policies, confidentiality agreements, and legal/contractual obligations.
- Consistency in attendance at required meetings or checkpoints.
- Professional behavior with internal teams, stakeholders, and clients.

Collaboration & Communication

- Timely reporting of progress, challenges, and solutions.
- Responsiveness to communication and instructions.
- Contribution to teamwork without undermining independence expected from a consultant.

Value Addition & Innovation

- Ability to suggest process improvements, cost savings, or innovative solutions.
- Knowledge transfer to permanent employees, where applicable.
- Building capacity for the organization beyond the contract period.

Cost-Effectiveness & Resource Utilization

- Delivery of services in alignment with budgetary constraints.
- Efficient use of company resources provided during the contract.
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C) Evaluation & Appraisal Process for Permanent Employees

- **Administrative & HR specific evaluation:** This segment will contribute 20 % of the total evaluation mark of 100. Detailed criteria under this segment has been detailed here : <external link : shall be defined by HR>
- **Departmental job description specific evaluation:** This segment will contribute 80 % of the total evaluation mark of 100. Detailed criteria under this segment has been detailed here : <external link : shall be defined by department leads>
- Employee appraisals shall be conducted based on both individual performance evaluation—including administrative and HR considerations as well as departmental job description requirements—and broader organizational and external factors such as the national economic

situation, the Company's growth, audited profit and loss (P&L) status, and investment or fundraising activities, with final decisions determined through a balanced consideration of these elements.

- In the event of man-made crises, acts of God, or other force majeure circumstances beyond the control of the Company, the scheduled salary appraisal of permanent Employees may be deferred. Furthermore, the Company may, if necessary, adjust salary payments by limiting disbursements to the basic salary in place of the full gross salary, subject to providing prior written notification to the affected Employees.
- Evaluations and appraisals for Permanent Employees shall be formally communicated by the HR Department to the concerned Employee in accordance with the provisions of this Policy. Such communications shall be considered final, and there shall be no further scope for consultation, appeal, or review before the Management Committee (ManCom).

3. **OFFICE AND WORK SCHEDULE**

A. **Hours of Work**

- a) The daily standard office hours of the Company shall be 8 (Eight) hours inclusive of any lunch break or interval. The daily standard office hours unless otherwise specified shall be as follows:

Sunday to Thursday 10:00 AM – 06:00 PM

b) **Late Attendance Policy**

An Employee shall be deemed to have arrived late if he/she reports to the office **ten (10) minutes** beyond the official starting hour of the office.

- Initial Deductions: For every **four (4) instances of late attendance** in any given month, **one (1) day of available paid leave** shall be deducted from the Employee's leave calendar on a priority basis in the following order: *Casual Leave, and then Annual Leave*. Sick leave is not included in this purpose.
- Subsequent Deductions: For every **three (3) additional instances of late attendance** beyond the initial four (4) days in the same month, an additional deduction of **one (1) day's basic salary** shall be applied. This rule shall continue to apply for every subsequent block of three (3) late attendances within that month. Late attendance count shall be reset at the beginning of every following month.
- In the event that no paid leave is available in the Employee's profile, the equivalent of **one (1) day's basic salary** shall be deducted.

c) **Authorized Late Login Policy**

An Employee may be permitted to log in late to the office for up to a maximum of three (3) days in any given month, provided that such lateness is supported by

legitimate reasoning and duly communicated in advance or, at the latest, on the same day of the late login. Acceptance of such reasoning shall rest solely at the discretion of the respective Reporting Lead/Team Lead.

Employees must obtain authorization for the late login within the same day of occurrence; otherwise, such late login shall not be considered authorized and will be treated as a regular late attendance subject to applicable deductions under this Rule Book.

Authorized late logins, once duly approved, shall not be counted towards the late attendance records for the purpose of leave or salary deductions.

c) **Short Leave, Early Leave, and On-Field Office Duty Policy**

Employees availing short leave, early leave, or on-field office duty (full-day or partial-day) must first log into the office system and thereafter submit an application through the prescribed system. Such applications shall remain subject to the prior approval of the respective Team Lead.

Any Employee who proceeds on short leave, early leave, or on-field office duty without submitting the required application through the system and obtaining prior approval may have such absence recorded and treated, at the discretion of the Company, as **late login, leave, or absence**, in alignment with the Employee's available leave quotas and the applicable provisions of this Rule Book.

- d) The Employees shall record their attendance through the software provided by the Employer, called Employee Management System. The same software shall be used by the Employer for allocating tasks to the Employees and for conducting performance appraisal of the Employees.
- e) Each Employee's principal nature of work shall be stipulated in the Employment Agreement and the daily tasks shall be communicated to him/her from time to time.
- f) Employees shall be entitled to 1(One) day's weekly holiday, i.e., on Fridays and Saturdays. If an Employee is required to work on a weekly holiday due to pre-scheduled work, training, meeting with foreign clients or officials, or travel, he/she shall be allowed, as soon as circumstances permit, compensatory holidays, of equal numbers to the holidays so deprived. No Employee can be made to work for more than 10 (Ten) days consecutively without giving him/her the weekly leave.
- g) No female Employee shall, without her consent, be allowed to work in the Company between 10 PM and 6 AM. Such consent shall be obtained in Form 35 prescribed under Bangladesh Labour Rules, 2015(or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply). If consent is obtained, the Employer has to ensure necessary transportation facility and safety for the female Employee. The consent of the female Employee shall remain valid for 1 (One) month unless it has been revoked by the same through a written application. If the female employee decides to revoke her consent, she may do so by Form-36(KA) of the Bangladesh Labour Rules, 2015 (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply).

- h) In case if it is required to work beyond general working hours for any employee (Male/Female), sufficient health and safety measures shall be ensured according to company policy.

B. Attendance

- a) Every Employee is to be at work as scheduled, attend work regularly and shall exercise reasonable care, skill and diligence in every work assigned to him/her.
- b) The Employees shall notify his/her supervisor/Human Resource Officer of any unscheduled absence no later than one hour after the scheduled time to report to work.
- c) Whenever it is necessary the Employee should make arrangements to have any critical work assignments covered by someone else (Reliver), or at least let his/her supervisor know of the course of actions required to be taken in his/her absence.
- d) Employees are strongly advised to provide attendance using their ID cards/EMS on a regular basis. Lost of ID card shall be compensated by a Tk. 200 penalty, upon paying which, a new ID card will be issued to the employee by HR.
- e) Habitual absence or tardiness will result in disciplinary action. Employees are advised to plan ahead for any annual leave and other time off. All Employees should give at least 7 working days' written notice for annual leave, subject to the approval of his or her supervisor.

4. COMPENSATION

A. Salary Determination

- a) The salary scale for a given position is based on its duties as well as the level of skills and expertise required. An individual Employee's salary in a position is also based on her/his salary history and professional accomplishments.
- b) The Employer's policy is to ensure that salaries and benefits provided to the Employees are consistent with the prevailing laws and compensation practices in Bangladesh.

B. Salary Payment

Salaries are paid monthly, in local currency, within the 7th (Seventh) working day of the current month. The salaries are paid in the respective bank accounts of the Employees.

C. Income Tax Withholding

The Employer shall deduct income taxes from all its Employees' salaries in accordance with the applicable provisions of the Income Tax Act, 2023 (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply).

5. BENEFITS

A. Festival Bonus

All full-time employees who have completed less than one (1) year of continuous service shall be entitled to one (1) festival bonus in that year, and all employees who have completed at least one (1) year of continuous service shall be entitled to two (2) festival bonuses per year, each festival bonus being equivalent to one hundred percent (100%) of the employee's basic monthly salary at the time of payment.

B. Maternity Benefit

- a) Every female Employee is entitled to paid leave in respect of the period of 8 (Eight) weeks preceding the expected day of her delivery and 8 (Eight) weeks immediately following the day of her delivery.
- b) No female Employee shall be required to do any work which is of an arduous nature or which involves long hours of standing or which is likely to adversely affect her health, if:
 - i. Anyone from the Company has reason to believe or if the female Employee has informed the Employer that she is likely to deliver a child within 10 (Ten) weeks;
 - ii. To the knowledge of the Employer, the woman has delivered a child within the preceding 10 (Ten) weeks.
- c) Every female Employee shall be entitled to maternity benefit from the Employer for the period of 8 (Eight) weeks preceding the expected day of her delivery and 8 (Eight) weeks immediately following the day of her delivery. The female Employee has to, on any day, give notice either orally or in writing in the prescribed Form 18 under Bangladesh Labour Rules, 2015 (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply) to the Employer that she expects to be confined within following 8 (Eight) weeks and have to, therein, nominate a person for purposes of receiving payment of her maternity benefit in case of her death. In case of giving oral notice by the female Employee, the person responsible from the Company for granting the leave will record this in the leave application form (Form 18) and take the signature or thumb impression of the concerned female Employee. The female Employee shall inform the Company after delivery of her child in accordance with Form-18(KA) as provided under Bangladesh Labour Rules, 2015 (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply).

While calculating the amount of maternity benefit under section 48(2) of Bangladesh Labour Act 2006 (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply), the Employee's last total monthly wages shall be divided by 26 (Twenty-Six) to determine her average salary per day. Furthermore, if there is any system of provident fund, that shall be deducted from her monthly salary in accordance with the law.

- d) In order to be entitled to the maternity benefit stated above, the female Employee must have worked for a period of not less than 6 (Six) months immediately preceding the day of her delivery. Furthermore, no maternity benefit shall be payable to a female Employee if at the time of her delivery she has 2 (Two) or more surviving children, in that case she may enjoy any leave which is due to her. Any leave due to her maternity, shall mean the annual and medical leave. In case of adjusting the medical leave, the pregnancy certificate will be considered as a medical certificate. Moreover, if additional leave is required even after adjusting the above-mentioned leave then the Employer can grant the Employee then concerned leave without any payment. Furthermore, if the female Employee delivers a child after the time period of 8 (Eight) weeks of her scheduled delivery date, then the concerned days shall be adjusted under the annual and medical leave.
- e) If a female Employee suffers a miscarriage before the scheduled date of going on maternity leave, she is entitled to take a leave for the next 4 (Four) weeks on grounds of health. In this case, neither the female Employee's salary shall be deducted nor shall it be adjusted with any other leave.
- f) If any post-delivery pregnancy benefit is required to be paid and the female Employee is unable to take such benefit in person, the same should be given to any person authorised by her in writing.
- g) If any notice or order of discharge, dismissal, removal or otherwise termination of employment is given to a female Employee within a period of 6 (Six) months before and 8 (Eight) weeks after her delivery and such notice or order is given without sufficient cause, she shall not be deprived of any maternity benefit to which she would be entitled if such notice or order has not been given.
- h) Conduct towards female pregnant Employees: The Employees and the Employer shall have the following responsibilities towards female pregnant Employees:
 - (i) Refrain from behaving in a manner or making any comment that would make her feel physically or mentally insulted or humiliated;
 - (ii) Refrain from engaging her in any work that is hazardous or could potentially be hazardous to her health;
 - (iii) Give her risk-free and hazard-free work;
 - (iv) Give her priority when it comes to using the lifts and elevators;
 - (v) After delivery of the child, ensure that she has the opportunity and proper environment to breastfeed her child.

A. Incentive and Performance Recognition Policy

i) Regular Job Responsibilities

Employees performing well within their regular working hours and fulfilling their duties as per their assigned Job Description (JD) and Key Performance

Indicators (KPIs) shall be deemed to be satisfactorily discharging their responsibilities. Such performance, while commendable, shall not by itself entitle the Employee to any additional incentives, bonuses, or rewards.

ii) Performance Beyond Job Description and Hours

Employees who perform beyond the scope of their regular JD or standard working hours, demonstrate leadership, ownership of tasks, or contribute significantly to organizational growth may be considered for incentives, bonuses, or gifts. Recognition may be made on an occasional, quarterly, bi-annual, or annual basis, as determined by the Company.

1. Sales and Funding Functions

- a. Employees working directly in sales, business development, and non-refundable funding processes may be eligible for incentive payments upon the realization of successful leads or funds.
- b. Incentives shall be payable only after the transaction amount has been duly credited to the Company's account, either in full or in tranches, as applicable.
- c. The structure, calculation method, and disbursement modality of such incentives shall be separately disclosed in writing (email/official letter) to the relevant team members.
- d. The final decision on such incentives shall rest solely at the discretion of the Department Lead, subject to approval by Management. Employees in this category may not be entitled to the highest rates of annual salary appraisal, given the availability of direct incentive opportunities.

2. Other Departments (e.g., Technology, Administration, Compliance, Operations, etc.)

- a. Employees in non-sales departments may also be considered for performance-based recognition in the form of financial bonuses, gifts, vouchers, privilege cards, or other non-monetary benefits.
- b. The nature and extent of such incentives shall remain at the sole discretion of the respective Department Lead, subject to Management oversight.

3. Documentation and Transparency

- a. Claims for any incentive must be substantiated with documented evidence/logs of the additional work performed or contributions made.
- b. Such claims shall be verified independently by both the Department Lead and the Human Resources (HR) Department.
- c. To ensure fairness and transparency, the Department Lead may not override HR's decision in matters relating to incentive approval.

II. Limitations on Incentives

- A. At the present stage of the Company's growth, no incentive, bonus, or benefit shall be provided to Employees for outstanding performance beyond what is expressly stipulated in this Policy. The Company reserves the right to review and revise this clause periodically in line with global best practices and the evolving financial capacity of the organization.

III. Taxation and Statutory Compliance

- 1. All monetary incentives, bonuses, or allowances provided under this Policy shall be subject to applicable taxes, deductions, and statutory contributions as required under the prevailing laws of Bangladesh and/or any other relevant jurisdiction.
- 2. The Company shall deduct such amounts at source in accordance with applicable payroll and compliance policies.
- 3. Non-monetary incentives (e.g., vouchers, gifts, privilege cards) shall also be structured in compliance with relevant tax regulations to the extent applicable.

B. Death Benefit

- (i) If an Employee passes away while in service, after a continuous service of not less than 2 (Two) years, his/her nominee, or in the absence of a nominee his/her dependent, shall be paid by the Employer a death benefit at the rate of 30 (Thirty) days' basic salary for every completed year of service, or for any part thereof in excess of 6 (Six) months.
- (ii) Where such Employee passes away while working at the premises of the Employer or following a workplace accident, the death benefit shall be calculated at the rate of 45 (Forty-Five) days' basic salary for every completed year of service, or for any part thereof in excess of 6 (Six) months.
- (iii) In addition to the death benefit, the deceased Employee shall also be entitled to severance pay equivalent to that payable for retirement as per the clause titled as "Retirement" of this Cultural Rule Book (CRB).
- (iv) If any Employee passes away while having unused annual leave with wage benefit payable, the salary against his/her unused annual leave will have to be paid to his/her heirs or to the person nominated by him/her.
- (v) If a female Employee entitled to maternity benefit passes away at the time of her delivery or during 8 (Eight) weeks following thereof, the Employer shall pay the amount of maternity benefit, if the newly born child survives, to the person who takes care of the child, and if the child does not survive to the person nominated by her, or if there is no such nominee, to her legal representative. If a female Employee passes away during the period for which she is entitled to maternity benefit but before giving birth to a child, the Employer shall be liable to pay such benefit for the period preceding and including the day of her death, provided that

if any such benefit already paid to her exceeds the amount of such benefit now payable shall not be recoverable, and if any amount in this regard is due to the female Employee till the time of her death, the Employer shall pay it to the nominee of the female Employee, or if there is no nominee, to her legal representative.

6. LEAVE ALLOWANCES AND RECORDS

A. Procedure for leave in advance

- (i) Any employee who intends to obtain leave of absence in advance shall submit an application through the Company's Employee Management System (EMS), or in written form where EMS is not available, stating his/her address and communication details during the period of leave. The employee shall also designate a reliever, acceptable to the Company, who will provide necessary inputs or updates on his/her behalf during the leave period.
- (ii) The employee's supervisor must issue a decision on any leave application within 7 days of receiving it, or at least 2 days before the requested leave begins—whichever comes first. However, if the leave is requested to start on the same day or within 3 days of the application, the supervisor must provide a decision on the same day the application is submitted.
- (iii) If the leave asked for is granted, a leave pass via an email shall be issued to the Employee.
- (iv) If the leave asked for is refused or suspended, the fact of such refusal or postponement and the reasons thereof shall be communicated to the Employee before the date on which the leave would have expected to be commenced and it shall be recorded in the register maintained for the purpose.
- (v) All Employees shall resume duties on the expiry of leave initially sanctioned or as subsequently curtailed or extended. During the leave period, the Employee will be entitled to full salary for approved leave except leave without pay.
- (vi) If any Employee, after he/she went on leave, desires an extension thereof, he/she shall, if such leave is due to him/her apply in writing by registered post or email before reasonable time of the expiry of the leave to his/her supervisor who shall send a written reply either granting or refusing the extension of leave.

B. Festival Holidays

- (i) Employees are entitled to 11 (Eleven) days of paid festival holiday every calendar year. The Employer shall follow the schedule of public holidays declared by the Government of Bangladesh (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply) to the extent possible the Company and shall finalize a yearly holiday list, in consultation with the Employees insofar as practicable.
- (ii) The Employer shall publish amongst all Employees the list for the following year by the 31st of December of the current year.

- (iii) If an Employee is required to work on a festival holiday, he/she shall be allowed, as soon as circumstances permit, with 2 (Two) days substitute holiday.

C. Annual Leave (Vacation)

- a) Every Employee, who has completed 1 (One) year of continuous service in the Company shall be entitled to, during the subsequent period of 12 (Twelve) months, 1 (One) day for every 18 (Eighteen) days of work. For the purposes of annual leave, an Employee shall be deemed to have completed a period of continuous service in an establishment notwithstanding any interruption in service that occurred during that period due to:
 - (i) Any holiday;
 - (ii) Any leave with wages;
 - (iii) Any leave with or without wages due to sickness or accident;
 - (iv) Any maternity leave not exceeding 16 (Sixteen) weeks;
 - (v) Any period of lay-off;
 - (vi) Any legal strike or any illegal lock-out.
- b) Any festival/weekly holidays falling during the period of annual leave shall be included in such annual leave.
- c) If an employee does not use all their annual leave within a 12-month period, the unused portion can be carried over to the next year, up to 50% of the current year's leave. However, no more than 60 days of unused leave can be carried forward in total. Any unused leave beyond 60 days will be forfeited at the end of the year. When an employee leaves the organization, they may receive payment for up to 60 days of unused annual leave. This payment is calculated by dividing the employee's last basic monthly salary by 30, then multiplying by the number of unused leave days.
- d) An employee can enjoy up to 5 (Five) days of cluster annual leave subject to availability of his/her total annual leave.
- e) Employees should give at least 5 (Five) working days' ahead of written notice for enjoying a cluster annual leave, subject to the approval of both their supervisors and HR. Sandwich leave provision shall not be applicable for such cluster annual leave deduction.
- f) Since annual leave is provided to Employees for the purpose of rest and relaxation, the full use of vacation time is encouraged. Because of the benefits resulting to both Employee and the Employer, supervisors should ensure that each Employee is allowed to take regular and sufficient leave each year.

D. Sick Leave

- a) The purpose of sick leave is to provide time off with pay when an illness or an accident outside of work makes it medically inadvisable for the Employee to work and to provide for a temporary period of recuperation.
- b) Every Employee is entitled to 14 (Fourteen) days of sick leave with salary in a

calendar year. While on sick leave, Employees shall receive 100% (One Hundred percent) of their salary and benefit allowances.

- c) An Employee shall be entitled to sick leave on a pro-rata basis if he/she joins the Company in any part of the year.
- d) The employee must inform their supervisor promptly in case of illness. Sick leave for 2 days or more shall require a certificate/ supporting documents from a registered doctor, stating the illness and recommended leave period. Without a valid certificate, the leave will be deducted from casual or annual leave, or treated as unpaid if no leave is available.
- e) Any festival/weekly holidays falling in the middle of the period of sick leave shall be counted as one of the days of sick leave. If such leave is taken before or after any festival/weekly holiday, the same shall not be included in the sick leave.
- f) If the Employee has used all her/his sick leave, he/she can use accrued annual leave instead.
- g) Unused sick leave cannot be accumulated and carried forward to the following year, neither can it be en-cashed at any time.

E. Casual Leave

- a) Every Employee is entitled to casual leave with salary for 10 (Ten) days in a calendar year.
- b) An Employee shall be entitled to causal leave on a pro-rata basis if he/she joins the Company in any part of the year.
- c) Any festival/weekly holidays falling in the middle of the period of causal leave shall be counted as one of the days of casual leave. If such leave is taken before or after any festival/weekly holiday, the same shall not be included in the causal leave.
- d) Unused causal leave cannot be accumulated and carried forward to the following year, neither can it be en-cashed at any time.

F. Maternity Leave

- a) All female Employees shall be entitled to maternity leave of 8 (Eight) weeks preceding the expected day of her delivery and 8 (Eight) weeks immediately following the day of her delivery.
- b) A request for maternity leave must be in writing in the prescribed Form 18 as provided under Bangladesh Labour Rules 2015 (or in accordance with other operational territories where it may apply), and shall be given to the supervisor at least 8 (Eight) weeks before the expected date of birth and such notice shall be supported by a medical certificate. Female Employees are encouraged to notify their supervisor as soon as the pregnancy is known to them.

- c) If the Employee needs additional time beyond the allowed maternity leave, she may use her annual leave, or may request unpaid leave. Sick leave may be requested if the absence is medically necessary.
- d) In the event of separation from employment, no payment will be made to the Employee for any unused maternity leave.
- e) The Employer shall not knowingly employ a woman during the 8 (Eight) weeks immediately following the day of her delivery.

G. Paternity Leave

- a. All confirmed full-time male employees who have completed a minimum of Twelve (12) months of continuous service shall be eligible for paternity leave.
- b. Each eligible employee shall be entitled to five (5) working days of paid paternity leave for first two childbirth.
- c. The leave must be availed either within fifteen (15) days prior to or fifteen (15) days following the date of delivery, and shall be taken in one continuous block.
- d. The employee shall apply for such leave through the Employee Management System (EMS) or, where EMS is not available, by submitting a written application, ordinarily at least seven (7) days in advance, except in emergency circumstances.
- e. The Company may require supporting documentation such as medical or hospital records confirming the expected or actual date of delivery.
- f. Paternity leave shall be non-cumulative, non-transferable, and non-encashable under any circumstances.
- g. Any absence in excess of the approved paternity leave entitlement shall be adjusted against annual or casual leave, or otherwise treated as leave without pay.
- h. **Menstrual Leave:**
- i. Menstrual leave is a privilege offered to the permanent employees (Probationaries may also enjoy) without any prior approval from the HR.
- j. Employees are required to submit online notification for such leave by EMS on due course.
- k. Maximum allowed paid menstrual leave is 2 days per employee per month.

H. Leave register

The Employer shall maintain a leave register containing the descriptions of casual leave, sick leave and annual leave and any additional descriptions under Form-9/ EMS. The leave register can be maintained in English or Bangla and upon request of the inspector, the Company shall provide a copy of it.

I. Leave book

Every Employee may be provided with a leave book in accordance with Form-9 / EMS which shall be considered the property of the Employee. All leave entries must be clearly written in ink and must include up-to-date information. The Company or the Employer cannot take or claim or hold the book for more than 7 (Seven) days consecutively except for inserting necessary information therein. If the leave book is maintained digitally, the printed copy for each Employee shall be considered as that Employee's leave book.

J. Unauthorized leave

Where an Employee is absent or has taken leave without authorisation, deductions from his/her wages for absence may be made for the whole or any part of the period during which he/she has been absent. The amount of such deduction shall, in no case, be more than the amount of wages payable to him/her for the period of absence and the Employee has to be informed in writing of such deduction. Wage shall mean the basic wage, allowances and ad-hoc or interim wages (if any) and the daily wage amount shall be calculated by dividing the basic wage, allowance and ad-hoc or interim wages (if any) by 30 (Thirty) days. The Employee has to be informed of the issue of deduction. In case of habitual practice of such unauthorized leave, an employee may face severe disciplinary consequences as mentioned in section **Separation From Employment**, clause no. C (i).

7. TEMPORARY STOPPAGE OF WORK

- a) The Employer may, at any time, if necessary, in the event of fire, sudden catastrophe, stoppage of power supply, epidemics, wide spread riots or any other cause beyond his control, stop any section or sections of the Company, wholly or partly for such period as the cause for such stoppage continues to exist.
- b) If such order of stoppage is given after the working hours have ended, the Employer shall notify the concerned Employees relating thereto, by a notice posted or hung on the notice board in the section concerned or at a conspicuous place and by email before the next working hour begins.
- c) Such a notice shall contain direction as to when the work shall be resumed and whether such Employees are to remain at their place of work at any time before the actual resumption of work.
- d) In the event of such stoppage occurring during working hours, the Employer shall, as soon as practicable, notify the Employees concerned relating thereto by a notice in the manner specified in this clause above and such notice shall contain direction as to when the work shall be resumed and whether such Employees are to remain at their place of work.
- e) Where Employees have been directed to stay at their place of work following such stoppage, the staying Employees may not get salary, if the period of their stay does not exceed 1(One) hour, and if it exceeds 1 (One) hour they shall get salary for the whole period.
- f) If the company properly notifies employees in advance, the affected workday may be rescheduled to another day.

8. SEPARATION FROM EMPLOYMENT

A. Termination Simpliciter

- (i) Simple termination by the Employer, commonly known as termination simpliciter, is applied when the Employer terminates an Employee, with or without assigning any reason, by serving the due notice or payment in lieu of such notice.
- (ii) Permanent Employee: A Permanent Employee may be terminated by serving 60 (Sixty) days' notice or payment of basic salary in lieu of such notice. Furthermore, considering compensation for employees with service period of 5 years or more, if any Permanent Employee is to be terminated (not by dismissal for misconduct that leads to forfeiture), he/she shall be paid compensation at the rate of 15 (Fifteen) days' basic salary for every completed year of service, along with other lawful benefits, if any.
- (iii) Temporary Employee/consultant: In the case of a Temporary Employee or Consultant, the employment shall automatically expire upon completion of the specified term of employment, unless renewed or extended in writing by the Company, in accordance with the provisions of the Bangladesh Labour Act, 2006 (as amended). If the employment is to be terminated prior to the expiry of the agreed term, the Temporary Employee or Consultant may be terminated by serving fifteen (15) to thirty (30) days' prior written notice, or by payment of the equivalent of basic salary in lieu of such notice, as consistent with the applicable provisions of the Bangladesh Labour Act 2006.

Notwithstanding the foregoing, termination may occur on an earlier date if expressly provided for in the individual contract or agreement executed with the Temporary Employee or Consultant, according to the section 27(4) of BLA 2006.

B. Resignation

- (i) Permanent Employee: If a Permanent Employee wishes to resign from employment, then he/she may resign by providing 60 (Sixty) days' notice or payment of basic salary in lieu thereof.
- (ii) If a Permanent Employee resigns, he/she shall be paid compensation at the rate of 15 (Fifteen) days' basic salary for every completed year of service when he/she has been in continuous service for more than 5 (Five), but less than 10 (Ten) years.
- (iii) If a Permanent Employee has completed continuous service for 10 (Ten) years or more, the compensation shall be paid at a rate of 30 (Thirty) days' basic salary for every completed year of service.
- (iv) Temporary Employee: A Temporary Employee may resign from the service by serving 30 (Thirty) days' notice or payment of basic salary in lieu of such notice, or whatsoever been mentioned on the specific contract signed with him/her.

C. Resignation by Conduct

- (i) If an Employee is absent for more than 10 (Ten) days without permission or notice, the Employer shall serve a notice to the Employee instructing him/her to show cause for such absence and to resume his/her employment within 10 (Ten) days in accordance with Bangladesh Labour Act (Section 27(4))
- (ii) If in such a situation the Employee does not show cause or resume employment within the stipulated period of time, then he/she shall be given further 7 (Seven) days' period to justify himself/herself.
- (iii) Where the Employee still does not resume employment or justify himself/herself, he/she shall be treated as having resigned by conduct from his/her employment from the first day of his/her unauthorized absence.

D. Retrenchment

- (i) Retrenchment means the termination of services of Employees by the Employer on the ground of redundancy.
- (ii) An Employee may be retrenched from service on the ground of redundancy. An Employee, who has been in continuous service for no less than 01 (One) year, shall be given 30 (Thirty) days' notice in writing, indicating the reasons for retrenchment, or shall be paid 30 (Thirty) days' basic salary in lieu of such period of notice. A copy of the notice shall be sent to the concerned authority or any other officer specified by the applicable law, and another copy to the collective bargaining agent of the Company, if any; and the notice shall include the following:
 - a) Name of the Company;
 - b) Name, designation and card number of the Employees;
 - c) Reason of retrenchment;
 - d) Date on which the retrenchment comes into effect;
 - e) Total duration of service;
 - f) Availability of the Employees:
 - i. Notice pay (in appropriate case);
 - ii. Gratuity or compensation whichever is applicable;
 - iii. The wages of the annual leave unenjoyed;
 - iv. Outstanding wages, other allowances and overtime allowance) if any);
 - g) Date of payment of the arrears.
- (iii) The Employee shall be paid compensation which shall be equivalent to 30 (Thirty) days' latest basic salary for every completed year of service.
- (iv) Retrenchment of any Employee should not be considered a negative reflection on the Employee.
- (v) Where an Employee of a particular category or department is to be retrenched, the Employer shall, in the absence of any agreement between him and the

Employee in this behalf, retrench the Employee who was the last Employee employed in that category or department in a LIFO (Last-in, First-Out) manner.

E. Lay-off

- (i) An Employee may be laid-off. If the period of stoppage of work of the Company exceeds 3 (Three) working days. Whenever an Employee who has completed at least 4 (Four) years of service under the Employer is laid-off, he/she shall be paid compensation by the Employer for all days during which he is so laid-off, except for weekly holidays. The amount of compensation shall be equal to half of the total of the basic wages and dearness allowance and ad-hoc or interim wages, if any, and equal to the full amount of housing allowance that would have been payable to him/her if he/she had not been so laid-off.
- (ii) Unless there is an agreement to the contrary between the Employee and the Employer, no Employee shall be entitled to the payment of compensation for lay-off for more than 45 (Forty-Five) days during any calendar year. If during a calendar year any Employee is laid-off for more than 45 (Forty-Five) days, whether continuously or intermittently, and after the expiry of such 45 (Forty-Five) days the period of lay-off is extended for further 15 (Fifteen) days or more, the Employee shall, unless there is an agreement to the contrary between the Employee and the Employer, be paid compensation for every subsequent period of lay-off for 15 (Fifteen) days or more. The amount of compensation shall be equal to one-fourth of the total of the basic wages and dearness allowance and ad-hoc or interim wages, if any, and equal to the full amount of housing allowance, if any.

In any case, during a calendar year, if an Employee is to be laid-off after the first 45 (Forty-Five) days as aforesaid, for any continuous period of 15 (Fifteen) days or more, the Employer may, instead of laying off such Employee, retrench him under clause 8(D).
- (iii) The Employer shall maintain a muster roll, and cause to be recorded therein the names of those Employees who may, from amongst the laid-off Employees, present themselves for work at the establishment during normal working hours.

F. Discharge from Services

An Employee may be discharged from service for reason of physical or mental incapacity or continued ill health certified by a registered medical practitioner. If an Employee who has completed not less than 4 (Four) years of continuous service is so discharged, he/she shall be paid compensation at the rate of 15 (Fifteen) days' basic salary for every completed year of service.

G. Retirement

- (i) An Employee is obliged to compulsorily retire at the age of 65 (Sixty Five), and his/her employment shall end on the last day of the month during which the Employee completes the age of 65 (Sixty Five) for both men and women. For the purposes of counting age of an Employee, the date of birth recorded in the Employer's service book of that Employee shall be conclusive proof. The

Employee who so retires shall be paid dues receivable by him as if he has been terminated or compensation at the rate of 15 (Fifteen) days' basic salary for every completed year of service, along with other lawful benefits, if any.

- (ii) Subject to mutual agreement between the Employer and the Employee, a retired Employee may be employed after retirement by a new contract.

H. Dismissal

- (i) An Employee may be dismissed without prior notice or payment in lieu thereof if he/she is convicted for any criminal offence or if he/she is found guilty of misconduct as provided herein.
- (ii) A dismissed Employee shall be entitled to compensation at a rate of 15 (Fifteen) days' basic salary for every completed year of service. In order to avail such compensation, the Employee has to be in continuous service for at least 4 (Four) years. The Employee shall not be entitled to compensation where he/she is dismissed for the following misconduct:
 - a) Theft, misappropriation, fraud or dishonesty in connection with business or property of the Employer; or
 - b) Disorderliness, riot, arson, or breakage in the Employer's office.
- (iii) A dismissed Employee shall have the opportunity of reinstatement to the original post or to any new post when he is acquitted on an appeal. Where reinstatement is not possible within the Company, the Employee shall be entitled to compensation at a rate equal to that of a discharged employee and such compensation shall be paid after excluding the compensation already paid for dismissal.
- (iv) An Employee may be asked to reimburse the Employer for any financial loss suffered as a result of his/her negligence.
- (v) No order for dismissal of an Employee shall be made unless:
 - a) The disciplinary procedure is completed and the misconduct is proven; and
 - b) The Board approves of such an order.

I. Payment of wages and amount in case of separation from employment

If the service of an Employee terminates, due to retrenchment, discharge, removal, dismissal, retirement, resignation or any other reason and any annual leave is due to him, the Employer shall pay him wages in lieu of the unavailed leave at the rate he is entitled to the payment of wages during the period of leave. Wages due to Employees owing to retirement, discharge, retrenchment, dismissal, termination or any other reason must be paid within 10 (Ten) working days following the date of cessation of employment and all

benefits and other dues must be paid within 30 (Thirty) working days following the date of cessation of employment.

J. Certificate of Service

The Employee shall be provided with a certificate stating the period of employment, duties and salary at the time of cessation of employment subject to issuance of subsequent severance documents (i.e. Accounts clearance certificate, Settlement Agreement, etc) within 10 working days from his/her last working day.

9. MISCONDUCT AND DISCIPLINARY ACTION

A. Misconduct

For the purposes of this Service Rules, misconduct shall include but shall not be limited to the following non-exclusive list of misconducts given below:

- (i) Willful insubordination or disobedience, whether alone or in combination with others to any lawful or reasonable decision of the Employer
- (ii) Theft, misappropriation, fraud or dishonesty with other Employees, stakeholder or the Employer
- (iii) Taking or giving bribes or any illegal gratification in connection with his employment or any other Employee's employment under the Employer
- (iv) Habitual absence without leaves of absence for more than 10 (ten) days without having any prior written/e-mail communication
- (v) Habitual late attendance
- (vi) Habitual negligence in work
- (vii) Habitual breach of any law or rule or regulation applicable to the Employer
- (viii) Habitual breach of any rule in relation to employment such as this Cultural Rule Book (CRB).
- (ix) Riot, disorder, arson/torching or vandalism in the establishment.
- (x) Habitual breach of any rule of employment, including conduct or discipline, act against communal harmony, etc.
- (xi) Falsifying, tampering with, damaging or causing loss of the Employer's official records.
- (xii) Reporting to work under the influence of alcohol, drugs, or other intoxicants, or possession of such substances in the workplace.
- (xiii) Physical assault, threats, bullying, or intimidation of any employee or stakeholder.
- (xiv) Unauthorized disclosure, misuse, or sharing of confidential information, trade secrets, or intellectual property of the Employer.
- (xv) Engaging in outside employment, business, or activities that conflict with the Employer's interests without prior written approval.
- (xvi) Unauthorized use or misuse of the Employer's funds, vehicles, IT systems, e-mail, or other resources.
- (xvii) Misuse of computers, internet, or digital platforms, including spreading hate speech, pornography, hacking, or unauthorized software use.
- (xviii) Harassment or discrimination based on gender, religion, ethnicity, disability, or political views.
- (xix) Willful or habitual violation of occupational safety and health rules, endangering self or others.

- (xx) Any act, speech, or social media activity that brings the Employer into disrepute.
- (xxi) Gambling, unauthorized collection of funds, or circulation of petitions in the workplace without approval.

B. Disciplinary Procedure:

(i) Show Cause/Explanation:

- a) Any complaint against any Employee shall be made in writing addressed to the human resource officer. Upon receipt of a written complaint, the human resource officer shall issue a show cause notice to the concerned Employee mentioning the charge and the time frame for submission of written explanation to the authority as to why disciplinary action should not be taken against her/him for misconduct. The time issued to the accused Employee for response shall be no less than 7 (Seven) days.
- b) The Employer shall consider the explanation of the Employee, if any, submitted within the specified time. Where no such explanation is submitted within the specified time or where the explanation is not satisfactory, the Employer may proceed with the next step of the disciplinary procedure, by fixing a date for the hearing of the complaint.

(ii) Suspension Pending Inquiry:

- a) Any Employee charged for misconduct may be suspended pending inquiry into the charge against him/her. During such period of suspension, the Employee shall be entitled to subsistence allowance and other allowances in full. Subsistence allowance means half of the basic wages, dearness allowance and ad hoc or interim wages, if any.
- b) An order of suspension shall be in writing and shall take effect immediately on delivery to the Employee. Unless the matter is pending before any court, the period of such suspension shall not be more than 60 (Sixty) days.
- c) If an Employee refuses to accept notice, letter, charge-sheet, order or any other document addressed to him/her by the Employer, it shall be deemed that such notice, letter, charge-sheet, order or the document has been delivered to him/her if a copy of the same is exhibited on the notice board and another copy is sent to the address of the Employee as available from the records of the Employer, by registered post.

(iii) Enquiry Committee:

- a) Upon receipt of written explanation from the concerned Employee which is not satisfactory, the Employer may form an enquiry committee to make formal enquiry into the matter. The enquiry committee shall consist of an equal number of representatives of both the Employer and the Employee and shall contain no more than 6 (Six) members. The committee may form a sub-committee and the sub-committee will submit a report to the enquiry committee for finalization. Subsequently, the

enquiry committee will send the report to the authority for necessary decisions.

- b) The Employer or any person deriving authority from the Employer shall nominate the Employer's representative(s) in the enquiry committee from within the Company.
- c) Similarly, the accused Employee shall nominate his representative(s) from amongst the Employees of the Company by a written proposal. The Employer may appoint an external person to enquire into the matter, if required.
- d) No party can nominate any representative who is working in the Company below the rank of the accused Employee or who is subordinate to the accused Employee.
- e) The enquiry shall be completed within 60 (Sixty) days.

(iv) Hearing:

- a) The Employer shall issue the notice of enquiry to the Employee to hold a hearing of the complaint which must specifically state the place, name of committee members, date and time for the hearing/enquiry and the member's right to ask and say anything related to the charges and enquiry, bring witnesses etc.
- b) The enquiry committee shall call on the accused Employee and read the charges against him/her. The accused Employee may reply to the questions and may make additional remarks which should be recorded in writing, by the enquiry committee. The accused Employee has the right to say and ask anything else or to produce any witness and may be assisted by another Employee of the Company nominated by him/her.
- c) If in an enquiry, any oral evidence is given by any party, the person against whom such evidence is given may cross-examine the witness. The statement of the witness(s) should be recorded and the witness must sign the paper on which his/her statement was recorded.
- d) The evidence in support of each party's case shall be recorded.
- e) Upon completion of the hearing, the enquiry committee shall read out the entire proceeding in presence of the accused Employee after which the Employee and the committee members will sign on every page of the minutes of the proceeding.

(v) Submission of Reports

The enquiry committee shall submit their full report on enquiry within 3 (Three) days to the Company along with their fact findings, comments and recommendations. The Company shall decide on the appropriate disciplinary action to be taken.

(vi) The Decision

- a) If on enquiry, an Employee is found guilty of any charges alleged, s/he shall not be entitled to his/her salary for any period of suspension for enquiry except subsistence allowance. If the Employee is acquitted, he/she shall be deemed to have been on duty during the period of suspension and shall be paid his/her wages for such period upon adjustment of the subsistence allowance already paid.
- b) In awarding punishment, the Employer shall consider the previous record of the accused Employee, the importance of the offence, credit and contribution during service and any existing special circumstances. The copy of the order inflicting the punishment must be supplied to the accused Employee.
- c) Dismissal is one of the punishments that can be given to an Employee found guilty of misconduct. In the light of justifying situations, an Employee may not be dismissed for misconduct but any other lesser form of punishment which includes: removal; demotion to a lower post, scale of pay or grade for not more than 1 (One) year; stoppage of promotion or withholding of increment for not more than 1 (One) year; fine; suspension without wages or subsistence allowance for a period not exceeding 7 (Seven) days; censure/reprimand or warning.
- d) If a fine is imposed, such amount cannot exceed 1/10 (One-Tenth) of the basic wages payable to the concerned Employee in a wage period.

10. SEXUAL HARASSMENT

A. Definition of sexual harassment

In case female Employees are appointed in the Company, the Employer has to make sure that they are prevented from any sort of sexual harassment or disrespectful behavior. Sexual harassment or disrespectful behavior includes unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and lewd, vulgar, or obscene remarks, jokes, posters, or cartoons, and any unwelcome touching, pinching or other physical contact, showing pornography, sending letters, calling over the phone, sending messages on phone, writing anything disrespectful on the walls of the bathroom or office, forcefully putting duress to obtain sexual favours, capturing still images or videos for the purpose of blackmailing the female employee, remaining absent in cultural or official functions by reason of sexual harassment, threatening or pressurizing after being rejected in regards to a love proposal and establishing or trying to establish a sexual relationship through fear or lies. Sexual harassment also occurs when a person in authority tries to trade job benefits for sexual favors. This can include hiring, promotion, continued employment or any other terms, conditions or privileges of employment and this is also called "quid pro quo" harassment.

B. Preventive Steps against sexual harassment

The Company shall take effective measures for prevention of sexual harassment. To discharge these obligations, they shall take, amongst others, the following steps:

- (i) Promote and cause awareness against any form of sexual harassment via verbal/written means;
- (ii) Maintain zero-tolerance policy against sexual harassment;
- (iii) Ensure clear harassment reporting procedures are in place;
- (iv) Constitutional and statutory provisions against gender discriminations and sexual harassment and punishment for the offences of sexual harassment and torture should be widely circulated;
- (v) Ensure that there is no hostile environment towards women at the workplace, and engender confidence and trust in female Employees that they are not placed in a disadvantaged position in comparison to their male colleagues.
- (vi) The Company shall issue a guideline for preventive measures against sexual harassment and it should be distributed amongst all the employees. Moreover, 1 (One) complaint box shall be installed at the workplace and the complaints should be noted down in a register that needs to be disposed of.

C. Complaints

All complaints against sexual harassment must be made to the complaint committee stated below in clause 10(E). The complaint can be lodged by the victim or through her relatives, friends or lawyer and it can alternatively be sent through mail. Alternatively, the complaint can be lodged with any female member of the complaint committee separately. It must be ensured that the identities of the complainant and the accused are kept confidential until the allegation is proved. Furthermore, security of the complainant will have to be ensured by the Company. No complainant will make any social media post or make any public announcement without exercising the procedures contained under this clause 10.

D. Complaint Committee

The Company will constitute a complaint committee in order to receive complaints of sexual harassment, and to conduct investigation and make recommendations. The complaint committee will have minimum 5 (five) members and the majority of the members will be women. The chair of the complaint committee shall be a woman. The complaint committee should have at least two independent members outside the Company, preferably from organizations working on gender issues and sexual abuse. Any member having an interest in the complaint, directly or indirectly, shall not form a part of the complaint committee for the complaint in issue. Such member(s) shall be promptly replaced by the Board. If the matter concerns any member of the Board, such member shall not be involved in any decision making of the process and the complaint committee shall in no way be influenced by any member of the Board under any circumstances.

E. Procedure of the Complaint Committee

The complaint has to be normally lodged to the complaint committee in writing within 60 (Sixty) working days from date of the occurrence. To verify the complaint:

- (i) The complaint committee will keep the identities of the complainant(s) confidential.
- (ii) In case of minor harassment, the complaint committee shall dispose of the complaint summarily within a maximum period of 3 (Three) working days and shall report to the Board. Such summary disposal of complaint shall only permit the Company if both the complainant and accused consent to it.
- (iii) The complaint committee will conduct hearings seeking oral and/or written representations from the complainant, accused and any witnesses. While recording the testimony of the complainant(s), any question or behaviour which is intentionally biased, insulting or harassing should be avoided. The testimony may be recorded on camera.
- (iv) The complaint committee shall seek to gather any other available and relevant evidence.
- (v) If the complainant wants to withdraw the complaint or stop the investigation, then the reason behind this has to be investigated and mentioned in the report.
- (vi) The complaint committee shall submit the investigation report with recommendation within 30 (Thirty) working days, from the date of receipt of the written complaint to the Board.
- (vii) If it is proved that a false complaint has been filed intentionally, then a report will be submitted to the Board recommending appropriate action against the complainant(s). The complaint committee will take decisions on the basis of the views expressed by the majority of its members.

F. Punishment

If the accused is found guilty of sexual harassment, the Board shall treat it as misconduct and take proper action according to this Service Rules within 10 (Ten) working days and/or shall refer the matter to the appropriate Court or tribunal if the act complained of constitutes an offence under any penal law.

11. GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

- (i) If an Employee considers himself/herself to be negatively affected or aggrieved by a decision of a supervisor or any other Employee or as a result of an incident that endangers his/her performance or that violates, misinterprets or inequitably applies the Company's rules and administrative decisions or any provision of the Service Rules, he/she should raise such concerns through the Company's grievance procedure. The Company's grievance procedure reflects a process which promotes open dialogue to resolve conflicts. The procedure will be conducted in keeping with the Company's values of trust and respect.
- (ii) An aggrieved Employee should consult first with his/her direct supervisor regarding actions, occurrences, or attitudes either expressed or implied, that are perceived as unfair or discriminatory.
- (iii) If a satisfactory resolution to the problem cannot be reached, the Employee, including an Employee who has been retrenched, discharged, dismissed, removed or otherwise removed from employment, and having grievance in respect of any matter related to terms of employment may seek redress thereof, by submitting his grievance to the Board, in writing, by registered post within 30 (Thirty) days of becoming aware of the cause of such grievance. If the Board accepts the complaint directly and acknowledges the receipt

thereof in writing, such complaint shall not be required to be sent by registered post.

- (iv) The Board shall within 30 (Thirty) days of receipt of the complaint, make enquiry into the complaint and shall after giving the concerned Employee an opportunity of being heard, communicate him/her in writing his/her decision thereon.
- (v) If the Employer fails to give a decision or where the concerned Employee is aggrieved with such decision, he/she may submit a complaint in writing to the Labour Court within 30 (thirty) days from the date of the decision of the Employer.
- (vi) No Employee shall, however, directly resort to any court proceeding against the Employer without first serving a grievance petition.

12. MISCELLANEOUS EMPLOYMENT POLICIES

A. General Code of Conduct

- (i) Representation: All Employees should remember that they are representing the Company at all times and should therefore not indulge in behavior that may compromise the integrity, respect or professionalism of the organization.
- (ii) Respecting laws and culture of Bangladesh: All Employees are obliged to be knowledgeable of and respect the laws of Bangladesh. They are required to familiarize themselves with and respect local culture, structures, beliefs, and customs.
- (iii) Conflict of interest: A conflict of interest exists when an Employee's personal interests are inconsistent with those of the Company and create conflicting loyalties. Employees must not take part in, appear to take part in or exert influence on any decision that may put their own interest in conflict with the best interest of the Company. The Company does not tolerate the practice of nepotism by Employees, including the preferential treatment without regard to merit of friends, family or other close relations in terms of recruitment, procurement or provision of support or in any other situation. For the avoidance of doubt, all matters including but not limited to recruitment, procurement or provision of support or in any other situation must always be based on merit, best judgement and common sense. Employees must not accept secondary employment without obtaining written consent of the Employer.
- (iv) Abuse of position: Employees shall not take unfair advantage of any person through manipulation, concealment, abuse of privileged information, misrepresentation of material facts, or any other unfair practice. Abuse of power includes but is not limited to favoritism, nepotism, corruption, and all forms of exploitation, including sexual exploitation.

B. Confidentiality

- (i) Confidential Information shall include the following:
 - a) Instructions given to Employees from time to time;
 - b) Database related information;

- c) Trade secret;
- d) Organization sensitive information;
- e) Financial information;
- f) Any information of the Company and its personnel including but not limited to members of Board, Employees and beneficiaries of its activities;
- g) Information of suppliers, customers, clients or vendors;
- h) Patent, formula, software, codes etc.;
- i) Password to any account, information, database, email, software etc.;
- j) Any information labelled as Confidential Information by the Employer.

The manner, form, type, format, style ("**Form**") and method of transmission is irrelevant for the purpose of construing information as Confidential Information as all Forms and methods of transmission of Confidential Information shall be regarded as Confidential Information. Furthermore, all copies, duplicates, reproduction, modifications, design, writings, reverse engineered, disassembled, and decompiled versions etc. of information regarded as Confidential Information shall also be regarded as Confidential Information.

- (ii) The Employee shall not disclose any confidential information to any third party without the written approval of the Board.
- (iii) On severance of the Employee's services, for any cause whatsoever, the Employee shall hand over to the Employer all property of the Employer for which he/she was responsible for the Company, together with documents, files, lists, notes executed by the Employee during the employment period and the said Employee shall retain no copy whatsoever.
- (iv) The confidentiality obligation on Employees shall extend beyond their Employment and any disclosure after cessation of Employment would require written approval of the Employer.

C. Anti-Corruption Policy

- (i) The misuse of office or power by any Employee for any personal gain shall be regarded as "Corruption". Corruption shall include but is not limited to bribery in the form of gift, entertainment, hospitality, facilitation, payments, etc.
- (ii) The Company is committed to providing a working environment that is corruption free and will not tolerate any corruption by any Employee, whether inside or outside the employment. Hence, the Employees shall not engage in any corruption or fraudulent activities whatsoever. Any activity of corruption or fraud shall constitute misconduct, with the implication including, but not limited to, dismissal.

D. Anti-Bullying

The Company prohibits workplace bullying. Workplace bullying is repeated inappropriate behavior, direct or indirect, whether verbal, physical or otherwise, conducted by one or more persons against another or others, at the place of work and/or in the course of employment, which could reasonably be regarded as undermining the individual's right to

dignity at work. Any activity of bullying shall constitute misconduct, with the implication including, but not limited to, dismissal.

E. Policy on Ethical Standards

- (i) Discovery of events of questionable, fraudulent or illegal nature which might be, or might appear to an outsider to be, in violation of the Company's standards and policies, must be reported immediately to a supervisor/the Board.
- (ii) The Company requires compliance by all Employees with all applicable laws and policies that pertains to maintaining the highest standards of integrity and ethical conduct, both in fact and in appearance. In addition, the Employees are expected to report any fraudulent acts they may witness.
- (iii) Anyone reporting such unethical activity shall have his/her identity protected and the Company shall ensure that he/she is no way adversely affected.

F. Social Media Use Policy

- (i) This policy provides guidance for Employee use of social media, which should be broadly understood for purposes of this policy to include blogs, wikipedia, microblogs, message boards, chat rooms, electronic newsletters, online forums, social networking sites, and other sites and services that permit users to share information with others in a contemporaneous manner.
- (ii) The following principles apply to professional use of social media on behalf of Company as well as personal use of social media when referring the Company:
 - a) Employees need to know and adhere to the Company's code of conduct and other Company's policies when using social media in reference to Company.
 - b) Employees should be aware of the affect their actions may have on their image, as well as Company's image.
 - c) Employees should be aware that the Company may observe content and information made available by Employees through social media. Employees should use their best judgment in posting material that is neither inappropriate nor harmful to Company, its employees, or customers.
 - d) It is highly recommended that Employees keep Company related social media accounts separate from personal accounts.
 - e) The Employees shall refrain from using social media while at work and/or on equipment provided by the Company, unless it is work-related.
 - f) The Employees shall not use an official email address to register on social networks, blogs or other online tools utilized for personal use.

G. Employee Wellbeing and Mental Health

The Company recognizes the importance of Employee wellbeing, including physical, mental, and emotional health, in fostering a productive and positive work environment. In this regard, the Company may, subject to its resources and organizational needs, introduce programs and initiatives aimed at supporting Employee wellbeing.

Such initiatives may include, but are not limited to:

- Awareness Programs: Workshops, training sessions, or communications on stress management, work-life balance, and emotional resilience.
- Counseling Support: Access to counseling services, either through in-house resources or external professionals, on a confidential basis.
- Wellbeing Activities: Team-building exercises, collaborative celebration of success, achievements, birthdays, relaxation space, or structured breaks via annual excursion, etc. that promote overall wellness.

Participation in such programs shall be voluntary and treated with strict confidentiality. Employees are encouraged to seek support where necessary, and the Company shall ensure that any such participation shall not adversely affect the Employee's performance evaluation, career progression, or workplace reputation.

The Company reserves the right to review, modify, or expand its wellbeing initiatives in line with global best practices and the evolving needs of its Employees.

H. Diversity and Inclusion

- (i) The Company is committed to gender equity and equality. Gender equity means fairness of treatment for women, men, and transgenders, according to their respective needs. This may include equal treatment that is different, but considered necessary to enable equal participation of women, men, and transgenders, in terms of rights, benefits, obligations and opportunities in their professional life. Gender equality means that the different behaviors, aspirations and needs of women, men, transgenders, girls and boys are considered, valued and favored equally and that they will be treated equally in respect of their rights, responsibilities and opportunities.
- (ii) The Company recognizes that supporting gender equity and equality is of paramount importance to ensuring a strong organization and a workplace free from discrimination.
- (iii) The Company does not discriminate in employment because of age, religion, tribe, race, color, gender, national origin, sexual orientation, disability, military status, marital status, family responsibility, station of life, political opinion, health (includes HIV/AIDS, pregnancy) socioeconomic status, or any other occupationally irrelevant criteria. Employment and promotion for any position are based on an individual's qualifications and merit.

- (iv) The Company does not tolerate any kind of discrimination on the basis of gender, race, caste, religion or belief, nationality, ethnic or social origin, age, sexual orientation, marital status, disability or other aspects of personal status.
- (v) The Company commits to the principle of equal opportunity, especially in all aspects of Employee relations, including employment, salary administration, and Employee development.
- (vi) All Employees shall refrain from discriminating in any way and must strive to increase diversity and inclusion to the greatest possible Company extent. The Company aims for its work to provide inclusive environments with equal opportunities for employment and development.

I. IT Security Policy

This policy identifies the rules and procedures for all Employees accessing and using the Company's IT assets and resources. The objectives of this policy are the preservation of confidentiality, integrity, and availability of systems and information used by Company's Employees. Violation of any provision of this policy shall amount to misconduct, with the implication including, but not limited to, dismissal.

- (i) Protect personal and company devices: When Employees use their digital devices to access company emails or accounts, they introduce security risk to data of the Employer. Employees must keep both their personal and company-issued computer, tablet and cell phone secure. They can do this if they:
 - a) Keep all devices password protected.
 - b) Choose and upgrade a complete antivirus software.
 - c) Ensure they do not leave their devices exposed or unattended.
 - d) Install security updates of browsers and systems monthly or as soon as updates are available.
 - e) Log into company accounts and systems through secure and private networks only.
 - f) Avoid accessing internal systems and accounts from personal/home/third party's devices, until or otherwise permitted in writing.
 - g) Avoid lending devices having access to Company's information or used for Company's work to third parties.
 - h) Avoid using office IT infrastructure (such as Chat GPT, Youtube etc) for vulgar or offensive content generation.
- (ii) Keep emails safe: Emails often host scams and malicious software (e.g. worms.) To avoid virus infection or data theft, Employees must:
 - a) Avoid opening attachments and clicking on links when the content is not adequately explained (e.g. "watch this video, it's amazing");
 - b) Be suspicious of clickbait titles (e.g. offering prizes, advice);
 - c) Check email and names of people they received a message from to ensure they are legitimate; and
 - d) Look for inconsistencies or giveaways (e.g. grammar mistakes, capital letters, excessive number of exclamation marks).

- e) Use email signatures, holiday offline notices, etc. as appropriate.
- (iii) Manage passwords properly: Password leaks are dangerous since they can compromise the Company's entire infrastructure. Not only should passwords be secure so they won't be easily hacked, but they should also remain secret.
- (iv) Transfer data securely: Transferring data introduces security risk. As such, Employees must:
 - a) Avoid transferring sensitive data (e.g. beneficiaries' information, Employee records) to other devices or accounts unless absolutely necessary. When mass transfer of such data is needed, Employees must seek written consent of the Board and/or assistance from any person authorised by the Board to provide such assistance.
 - b) Share confidential data over the company network/ system and not over public Wi-Fi or private connection.
 - c) Ensure that the recipients of the data are properly authorized people or organizations and have adequate security policies
 - d) Report scams, privacy breaches and hacking attempts.
- (v) Additional measures:

To reduce the likelihood of security breaches, Employee must:

- a) Turn off their screens and lock their devices when leaving their desks.
- b) Report stolen or damaged equipment as soon as possible to the Company to the human resource department/Board.
- c) Change all account passwords at once when a device is stolen.
- d) Report a perceived threat or possible Company's security weakness in the Company's systems.
- e) Refrain from downloading suspicious, unauthorized or illegal software on their company equipment.
- f) Avoid accessing suspicious websites.

Furthermore, the Employees must not do the following:

- a) Collect any data, data-storage, information or any extract of it from any computer, computer system, computer network, and moveable data-information storage system of the Company without written authorization or for reasons unassociated with performance of their duties.
- b) Intentionally insert or try to insert any virus or malware or harmful software into any computer, computer system, computer network, and moveable data-information storage system of the Company.
- c) Willingly cause or try to cause harm to data or data-storage of any computer, computer system, computer network, and moveable data-information storage system of the Company, or cause or try to cause harm to any programme saved in the computer, computer system, computer network, and moveable data-information storage system of the Company.

- d) Obstruct or try to obstruct a valid or authorized person's access into any computer, computer system, computer network and moveable data-information storage system of the Company by any means.
- e) Willingly create or sell or try to create or sell spam or send unsolicited electronic mails without permission of the sender or receiver, for marketing any product or service.
- f) Take service of any person, or deposit or try to credit the charge fixed for the service to the account of any other person fraudulently or by means of unfair interference to any computer, computer system, computer network and moveable data-information storage system of the Company.
- g) Preserve or abet to preserve any data-information of any governmental, semi-governmental, autonomous or statutory organization, or the Company by unauthorized access to any of the Company's computer, computer system, computer network and moveable data-information storage system

J. IT Equipment Use Policy

All Employees of the Company who use IT equipment, including laptops and multimedia devices, agree to the following guidelines and rules. Violation of these guidelines and rules will amount to misconduct, with the implication including, but not limited to, dismissal.

- (i) All computer and multimedia equipment purchases must be approved by the Company in writing prior to any purchases.
- (ii) The Employee agrees to follow all regulations and policies governing the use of IT equipment, as well as all applicable country laws including copyright and intellectual property laws pertaining to software and information.
- (iii) The Employees shall not remove or alter any identification labels or tags attached to/displayed on any equipment.
- (iv) Only software approved by the Company may be installed on computers. All software must be installed by such personnel of the Company who has been authorized in writing by the Board. Illegal use or transfer of copyrighted materials is prohibited.
- (v) The Employees agrees to handle all IT equipment carefully and protect it from potential sources of damage. The Employees also agree to store all IT equipment in a safe and secure location. If any loss, damage, or destruction of the Company's property is determined to be the fault of an Employee, such Employee shall respond to the Company for the repair and replacement costs. However, allowances will be made for normal wear and tear of equipment.
- (vi) Any data that is hosted on the IT equipment is the responsibility of the Employee. The Company does not respond to the Company and does not support data on local hard drives or portable devices. Employees must take measures to securely protect any and all data that resides on the devices.

K. Fair Hiring Policy

The objective of the Fair Hiring Policy of iPAGE GLOBAL INC. and its subsidiaries across the globe (the Company) is to ensure that all job applicants and employees are treated equally and fairly throughout the hiring process and their employment, regardless of age, gender, ethnicity, religion, disability, sexual

orientation, or any other characteristic that does not pertain to their job performance.

Policy Guidelines:

1. Non-Discrimination: All hiring practices, including advertising, interviewing, and selecting candidates, will be conducted without discrimination.
2. Recruitment: Recruitment will be openly advertised through diverse channels to attract a wide range of candidates. Job descriptions and requirements will be clearly defined and genuinely essential for the job.
3. Selection Process: Selection will be based on merit, qualifications, and abilities needed for the job. Interview panels will include diverse members where possible the Company, and all candidates will be assessed against the same criteria.
4. Training for Hiring Managers: All personnel involved in recruitment and selection processes will receive training on this policy and the importance of diversity and equal opportunity.
5. Record Keeping: Accurate records of all recruitment processes will be maintained to ensure transparency and accountability.
6. Feedback and Grievances: Feedback will be provided to unsuccessful candidates upon request, and a clear process will be in place for candidates to raise concerns about recruitment and selection processes.

L. Employee Feedback Policy

The Company values open communication and recognizes that Employee feedback is essential to building a transparent, inclusive, and continuously improving workplace. This Policy establishes guidelines to ensure that Employees have appropriate opportunities to express their views, raise concerns, and contribute ideas regarding Company matters.

1. Scope

This Policy applies to all Employees, regardless of employment category or level, and covers feedback related to:

- Workplace environment and culture
- Policies, systems, and processes mentioned in cultural rule book
- Leadership and management practices
- Suggestions for organizational growth and innovation
- Concerns regarding fairness, inclusion, or wellbeing

2. Channels for Feedback

Employees may provide feedback through any of the following channels:

Direct Manager/Team Lead: Open discussions during one-on-one meetings.

Human Resources (HR) Department: Formal submission via email, feedback forms, or scheduled meetings.

Anonymous Mechanisms: Where provided, Employees may submit feedback through anonymous surveys, suggestion boxes, or digital platforms.

3. Confidentiality & Non-Retaliation

- All feedback will be treated with due confidentiality, and Employees shall not face retaliation or adverse consequences for raising concerns in good faith.
- Anonymous submissions, where applicable, will be reviewed with the same seriousness as identified feedback.

4. Response & Action

- Feedback will be acknowledged, documented, and evaluated by the relevant Department Lead and HR.
- Action plans, if required, will be communicated to Employees in a transparent and timely manner.
- Suggestions contributing to measurable improvements may be recognized under the Company's Employee Recognition or Incentive Programs.
- Based on the significance and impact of the feedback, HR may, at its discretion, provide Employees with a written explanation where implementation is not possible.

5. Responsibilities

- Employees: Are encouraged to provide constructive feedback, supported by facts and suggestions for improvement.
- Team Leads/Managers: Must create an open environment where Employees feel safe to share feedback.
- HR & Management: Are responsible for ensuring fair review, appropriate action, and communication of outcomes.

6. Continuous Improvement

The Company may periodically conduct Employee Engagement or Satisfaction Surveys to gather structured feedback and benchmark progress on workplace improvements.

M. Remote & Hybrid Work Policy

This Policy applies to all Employees of the Company, unless otherwise restricted due to the nature of their role, contractual obligations, or operational requirements.

1. Definitions

- **Remote Work:** Performing job duties from a location other than the designated Company office, on a regular or occasional basis.
- **Hybrid Work:** A structured arrangement in which an Employee splits their work time between the Company office and an approved remote location.

2. Applicability

This Policy for remote and hybrid shall apply strictly under exceptional circumstances where normal office attendance is disrupted due to man-made crises, natural disasters, or uncontrollable circumstances, including but not limited to:

- Pandemics or public health emergencies
- Wars, political unrest, or security concerns
- Famine or major economic disruptions
- Natural calamities such as floods, earthquakes, cyclones, or other force majeure events
- Global talent attachment where in-person engagement is not a viable option (for remote employment)

Under regular circumstances, all Employees are expected to work from the designated office premises unless otherwise specified in their employment agreement. However, final approval rests with the respective Department Lead and HR, subject to operational needs.

3. General Guidelines

- **Work Hours & Availability:** Remote/hybrid Employees must adhere to their designated working hours, attend virtual/physical meetings, and remain available during core business hours.
- **Productivity & Performance:** Employees are expected to meet the same standards of performance, output, and deadlines as office-based Employees.
- **Communication:** Employees must stay connected via official communication tools (email, chat platforms, project management systems, etc.) and respond within reasonable timeframes.
- **Attendance Recording:** Remote/hybrid Employees must log their working hours through the Company's designated attendance system.
- **Confidentiality & Data Security:** Employees must ensure a secure work environment and comply with Company policies on confidentiality, IT usage, and data protection.
- **Work Location:** Remote work must generally be performed from the Employee's home or another approved country of employment, unless expressly authorized otherwise.

4. Hybrid Work Scheduling

- Hybrid Employees may be required to work from the office on specific days (e.g., 2–3 days per week, or as decided by the Department Lead). All day to day activities must be logged via a designated digital team management system (i.e, ClickUp, Trello, etc.).
- Attendance on certain days may be mandatory for team meetings, client interactions, or critical business operations.

5. Equipment & Resources

- The Company may provide necessary hardware, software, or allowances for remote/hybrid Employees, subject to budget and approval.
- Employees are responsible for the proper care and use of Company assets and must return them upon request or termination.

7. Health & Safety

- Employees are responsible for maintaining a safe and ergonomically sound remote workspace.
- The Company may issue guidelines to assist Employees in creating a safe home office environment.

8. Review & Termination of Arrangement

- The Company reserves the right to review, modify, or revoke any remote or hybrid work arrangement at its discretion based on business needs, Employee performance, or policy violations.
- Employees may request to alter or discontinue their arrangement with the prior approval of the Department Lead and HR.

N. Additional Employee Benefits

Advance Salary Policy

1. Eligibility

- Only Permanent Employees who have completed a minimum of **one (1) year of continuous permanent employment** with the Company shall be eligible to apply for advance salary.
- Advance salary shall not be available to Employees on probation, under notice of termination, or those intending to resign within two (2) months of the request.

2. Scope of Advance Salary

Subject to approval by the Company, the maximum advance salary entitlement shall be determined by the Employee's length of permanency within the Company as follows:

- **1 year – 2.5 years:** Up to **1 month's basic salary**
- **2.5 years – 3 years:** Up to **2 months' basic salary**

- **3.5 years – 5 years:** Up to **3 months’ basic salary**
- **5.5 years and above:** Up to **4 months’ basic salary or otherwise decided by the management.**

Employees may not automatically qualify for the maximum stipulated range. The actual advance granted shall depend on the Employee’s **overall performance record** (administrative compliance and departmental evaluation), as well as Company financial considerations.

3. **Application and Approval Process**

- Eligible Employees must submit a written application on prescribed format specifying the required amount and purpose of the advance.
- Applications shall be reviewed by the **HR Department** and recommended by the respective **Department Head**, before final approval by **Management/Finance**.
- Approval shall remain at the sole discretion of the Company.

4. **Repayment Terms**

- Advance salary shall be recovered through **installments deducted from monthly salary**, generally not exceeding **Six (6) consecutive months**.
- Repayment shall be made in line with the **Bangladesh Labour Act, 2006 (as amended)**, ensuring that no deduction reduces the Employee’s take-home wages below the statutory minimum wage or 50% of gross salary in any wage period.

5. **Precautionary Clauses**

- Employees who apply for advance salary shall not be permitted to **resign from the Company until the full repayment of the advance has been completed**.
- If an Employee submits resignation or seeks to separate from employment prior to full repayment, the outstanding advance shall be **deducted in full from final settlement dues** (salary, leave encashment, or any other payable amounts).
- Any attempt to obtain advance salary with the intent to resign within two (2) months of approval shall be considered **misuse of Company resources** and may lead to disciplinary/legal actions.

6. **Compliance**

This Policy shall be administered strictly in compliance with the provisions of the **Bangladesh Labour Act, 2006 (as amended)**, particularly with respect to lawful deductions, employee consent, and transparency of records.

Credit Card and Bank Loan Facility Policy

1. **Eligibility**

- Only Permanent Employees of the Company shall be eligible to apply for credit card or bank loan facilities under arrangements facilitated by the Company with financial institutions. The company may not provide any salary certificate for such purposes before becoming a permanent employee of the company.

- Eligibility shall remain subject to the financial institution's independent credit evaluation and approval.

2. **Scope of Facility**

- The Company may establish partnerships with banks or financial service providers to enable permanent Employees to access **credit card services, personal loans, or salary-backed loans** at preferential rates or terms.
- Such facilities shall be treated as a **personal arrangement** between the Employee and the financial institution. The Company shall bear no financial liability or guarantee obligations for such facilities.
- Permanent employees wanting to avail such benefits shall first apply for clearance from the HR and Accounts, and approval by a ManCom member on a prescribed format by the company, ahead of a reasonable time (not less than 7 working days) of such application to the Bank.
- All salary certificates must be approved by the accounts & HR executives, upon receiving approval from the management on letting the employee to avail such benefits from the partner banking institutions.

3. **Restrictions**

- **No Employee shall be permitted to use a colleague (co-worker or subordinate) as guarantor** for any loan or credit facility availed through these arrangements.
- Employees shall not, under any circumstances, compel or influence colleagues to act as guarantors for personal borrowings. Violation of this provision shall be treated as **misconduct** under this Rule Book.
- The Company shall have no obligation to intervene in disputes arising from misuse of credit facilities.

4. **Repayment and Compliance**

- Employees are solely responsible for repayment of loans and credit card dues as per their agreement with the financial institution.
- Any default, dishonor, or misuse that damages the Company's reputation may be subject to disciplinary action.
- The Company may, if required by law, facilitate recovery of dues through salary deduction, subject to compliance with the **Bangladesh Labour Act, 2006 (as amended)** regarding lawful deductions.

5. **Discretionary Nature**

This facility is a **discretionary financial benefit**, and the Company reserves the right to amend, suspend, or withdraw its support for such arrangements at any time, without prior notice.

Health Benefit Policy

1. Legal Compliance

The Company shall provide health-related benefits to Employees in compliance with the provisions of the **Bangladesh Labour Act, 2006 (as amended)**, including medical facilities, sick leave, and financial support in cases of workplace injury, or illness (where the company is responsible), as applicable under the law and company policy. Chronic illness aggravated at an office work place in an unprecedented format shall not be covered under this policy.

2. Insurance Coverage

- The Company shall arrange a **group health insurance scheme** for all permanent Employees, The **Company will bear 50%** of the total health insurance premium cost for each employee, while the **remaining 50%** shall be borne by the employee. (**Who are willing to enjoy the Health Insurance benefit**).
- The health insurance package will cover a **maximum of four (4) individuals** — the **employee, spouse, and up to two (2) children**.
- **Parents are excluded** from this coverage.
- Within the family coverage, **each individual can utilize a maximum of 50% of the total insurance amount**, ensuring that **no single person may consume more than 50%** of the total family coverage limit. If someone is unmarried he/she can fully utilize the full amount.
- Each employee will be notified of the specific coverage package applicable to their position, as outlined below:
- Assistant Executive, Executive, Senior Executive, Assistant Manager, Manager will be under the gold Package.
- Senior Manager, General Manager / Head of Function, Assistant Vice President (AVP) / Director, Vice President (VP) under the Silver Package.
- Senior Vice President (SVP), Executive Vice President (EVP), Director / Executive Director / CXO under the Platinum Package.
- Hospitalization, surgical care, accident coverage, and critical illness benefits, subject to the terms and conditions of the policy provided by the insurer.
- Female employees shall be eligible for maternity and pregnancy-related medical benefits **only after completion of six (6) months of continuous employment** with the Company.
- All pregnancy-related claims and reimbursements shall be governed by the terms and conditions of the insurer's maternity coverage policy.
- All benefits are subject to the **limitations, exclusions, and policy terms** defined by the insurance provider.

3. Administration and Claims

- Claims under the insurance scheme (where available) shall be processed directly with the insurer, with assistance from HR.
- Where an insurance system is in place, expenses must be supported by appropriate documentation/receipts for validation.
- The Company reserves the right to review, revise, or modify the health benefit structure in line with **cost, coverage, and organizational needs**, while maintaining compliance with the BLA.

Employees will be formally informed of:

- The insurance coverage applicable to their grade;
- The renewal period and claim procedures; and
- Any revisions to the policy or benefits as approved by management.

O. Office Dress Code and Personal Hygiene Policy

The Company expects Employees to maintain a professional appearance and personal hygiene at all times, as it reflects the image and reputation of the organization. Dress standards and hygiene practices shall vary according to the nature of the Employee's role, as detailed below:

1. Sales, Marketing, Public Relations, Business Development, Administration, Human Resources Employees & Support Staff

- Employees in these roles, being client-facing or representing the Company externally, are required to dress in **strictly formal or business casual attire**.
- **Acceptable examples include:**
 - Plain formal shirts, pants, blazers, or suits (tie optional unless required).
 - Business casuals such as collared shirts, chinos, formal skirts, or blouses.
 - Formal shoes or closed-toe office footwear.
 - For support staff/lab assistants, it is mandatory to use specific office dress codes.
- **Unacceptable attire includes:** round-neck t-shirts, narrow jeans, slippers, casual caps, or attire unsuitable for a business setting.

2. Other Departments (e.g., Technology, Operations, Compliance, etc.)

- Employees in these roles may follow a **slightly flexible dress code**, provided it remains neat, professional, and workplace-appropriate.
- **Acceptable attire includes:** polo-shirts, smart casual shirts, plain formal, regular jeans, gabardins, modest tops, and clean sneakers or office-appropriate footwear.
- **Prohibited attire includes:**
 - Round-neck t-shirts with prints/logos, sleeveless or revealing dresses.
 - Party wear, distressed, narrow, or torn jeans, shorts, or flip-flops.
 - Overly casual or inappropriate outfits (i.e., lungi, 3 quarters, shorts, sports wear, etc) that compromise professionalism.

3. Self-Hygiene Standards

Employees are expected to maintain personal hygiene and workplace cleanliness, including:

- **Mouth Odor:** Ensure proper oral hygiene; avoid bad breath during office hours, especially in client-facing roles.
- **Body Odor:** Maintain good grooming and use deodorants/perfumes to prevent unpleasant odor.
- **Workstation Cleanliness:** Keep personal desks/work areas clean, tidy, and free from clutter, ensuring a healthy and professional environment
- **Common Space Cleanliness:** Employees must use common spaces (i.e., kitchen, pantry, terrace, washroom, etc) facilities responsibly, leaving them clean for the next user. Misuse, neglect, or unhygienic practices in shared facilities will be treated as misconduct.

4. Special Occasions

On designated days (e.g., cultural events, casual Thursdays, or celebrations), the Company may relax dress standards. Guidelines will be communicated in advance.

5. Management Discretion

Department Heads and HR shall have the authority to guide Employees on adherence to the Dress Code and Hygiene Standards. Repeated violations may result in warnings or disciplinary action in accordance with Company policy.

P. Professional Improvement and Employer-Sponsored Development

1. Eligibility

Permanent Employees who have completed at least **one (1) year of continuous service** with the Company shall be eligible to apply for professional development support/scholarship in the form of Company-sponsored courses, certifications, or training programs directly relevant to their role or career growth within the organization, whereas relevance of such attachments shall be determined by the team-lead/ManCom's approval.

2. Reimbursement Method

- Employees approved for such professional courses shall enjoy a full/partial reimbursement/scholarship against the **course or training expenses**.
- Upon successful completion of the course and submission of **valid supporting documents** (invoices, payment receipts, completion certificates, and notes/articles) as required by the HR Department or the respective Department Head, the Employee shall be reimbursed the actual expensed amount.

3. Discretionary Nature

All sponsorships and reimbursements under this clause are subject to the Company's discretion, financial capacity, and alignment of the training with organizational needs. The Company reserves the right to approve, reject, or modify any request

13. CONCLUSION

As an evolving document, this Cultural Rule Book (CRB) is subject to change. The Cultural Rule Book (CRB) shall be effective as of **2nd November, 2025, vested by the power of the board of directors of IPAGE GLOBAL INC. and applicable for its subsidiaries and affiliates across the globe.**